



CHAPTER ONE



Create alliances



Chapter Summary

In this chapter, the importance of building alliances in a new role is emphasized, illustrated through Alexia Belenko's experiences at MedDev. Alexia learns that success in her new position depends on navigating the complexities of influence among peers and superiors rather than relying solely on her positional authority. The chapter outlines strategies for identifying key stakeholders, understanding their motivations, and crafting influence strategies that promote collaboration. Building a 'relationship bank account' early on is critical to garner support for initiatives and ensure organizational success. This chapter serves as a guide for leaders to foster essential relationships that enhance their ability to implement change effectively.



The Challenge of Influence

In a new role, the challenge often lies in influencing others rather than relying on authority alone. Building support requires an understanding of the dynamics at play and the stakeholders involved. Recognizing the need for alliance-building is crucial for achieving early wins.

"To succeed, you must build alliances that transcend authority."

Understanding Your Stakeholders

Every new role comes with a range of influential players. Identify who holds power, who supports your vision, and who may resist change.

Understanding these dynamics allows you to tailor your approach more effectively.

"Mapping influence networks paves the way for strategic engagement."

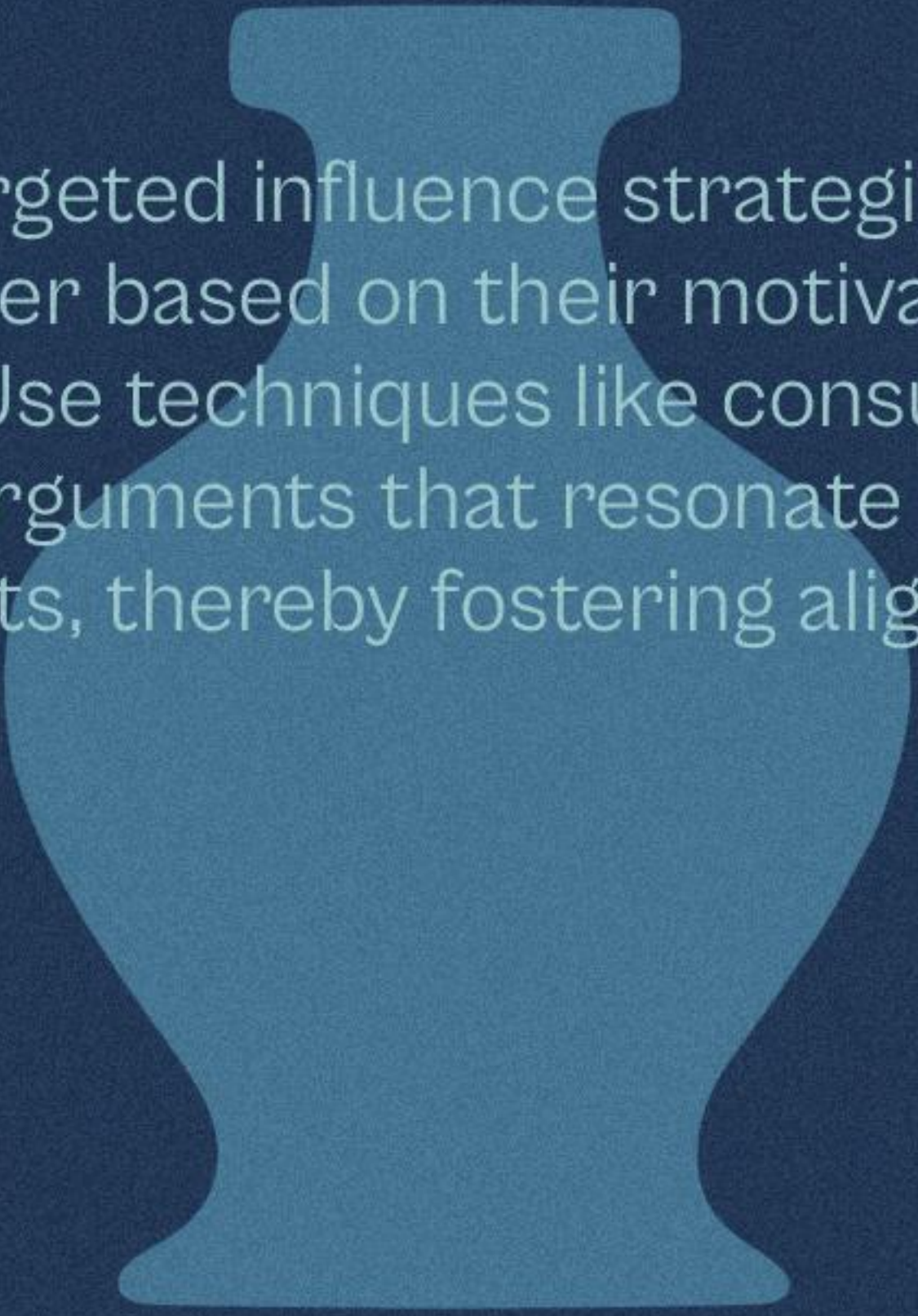
Building Your Relationship Bank

Invest early in relationships that matter. It's essential to cultivate a 'relationship bank account' which can provide dividends when you need support for your initiatives. Start by reaching out to key players in your organization.

Identifying Support and Resistance

Not all players are alike. Some will support your changes, while others may oppose them due to various reasons. It's important to assess who is likely to say yes, who may resist, and who sits in the middle.

Crafting Influence Strategies



Develop targeted influence strategies for each stakeholder based on their motivations and concerns. Use techniques like consultation and framing arguments that resonate with their interests, thereby fostering alignment.

Using Incrementalism

Gradual changes can help avoid resistance. By taking small steps toward a goal, you build acceptance and create a path for more significant changes down the line. This strategy allows for reflection and adjustment.

Forming Winning Alliances

Your aim is to create winning alliances, combining supporters from different segments of the organization. Collaborate with decision-makers to ensure your proposals gain traction and avoid potential blockages.



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Mapping Out Influence Networks



Create a visual diagram of who influences whom within your organization. This map will help you navigate complex relationships and identify key paths to influence stakeholders effectively.

The Power of Collaboration



Ultimately, success comes from collaboration and mutual support. Engaging with others builds momentum for change and fosters a culture that embraces cooperation over competition. Make partnership your priority.



Recap

- "To succeed, you must build alliances that transcend authority."
 - "Mapping influence networks paves the way for strategic engagement."
 - "Consultation engages allies, making them more invested in outcomes."
 - "Small wins lead to big victories over time."
 - "A united front makes for a powerful change initiative."
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Thank You

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